

# ITALY

Key Country Details Table

| Detail             | Information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| Full Name          | Italian Republic                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Short Form         | Italy                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Capital            | Rome                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Region (UN)        | Western Europe and Others Group (WEOG)                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Government Type    | Parliamentary Republic                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Head of State      | President Sergio Mattarella                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Head of Government | Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Currency           | Euro (€)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| UN Member Since    | 14 December 1955                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| MUN Standing       | Italy is a major contributor to peacekeeping, development, and humanitarian aid. It plays an active role in UN bodies including the Security Council, HRC, WHO, and ECOSOC, and promotes multilateralism, human rights, and international law. |

## Book Recommendations

| Title                                                     | Author(s)                        | Why It's Relevant                                                                  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Italy and the United Nations</i>                       | Andrea Bosco                     | Comprehensive overview of Italy's diplomatic presence and evolution within the UN. |
| <i>Italian Foreign Policy in the Post-Cold War Period</i> | Filippo Andreatta                | Analyzes Italy's multilateral strategy and foreign affairs after 1990.             |
| <i>Italy in International Relations</i>                   | Ettore Greco, Alessandro Colombo | Details Italy's contributions to peace, EU policy, and international law.          |
| <i>The Europeanisation of Italian Foreign Policy</i>      | Caterina Carta                   | Explains how EU and UN membership have shaped Italy's global actions.              |

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| <i>Italy in the Security Council</i> | Istituto Affari Internazionali (IAI) | Focuses on Italy's UNSC terms, voting patterns, and reform advocacy. |
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## Italy: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

| Source Name                                             | Link                                                                                                                                                                          | Why It's Useful                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Italy's Candidature and Term at the UNHRC (2019–2021)   | <a href="https://italyun.esteri.it/rappresentanza_onu/en/italy-and-the-un/human-rights/">https://italyun.esteri.it/rappresentanza_onu/en/italy-and-the-un/human-rights/</a>   | Describes Italy's positions, pledges, and contributions during its HRC membership.   |
| UN Web TV – Italy at UNHRC                              | <a href="https://webtv.un.org/search?term=italy%20human%20rights%20council">https://webtv.un.org/search?term=italy%20human%20rights%20council</a>                             | Video archives of Italy's statements, resolutions, and interventions at the Council. |
| Italian Coalition for Civil Liberties and Rights (CILD) | <a href="https://cild.eu/en/">https://cild.eu/en/</a>                                                                                                                         | Prominent NGO working on refugee rights, prison reform, and anti-discrimination.     |
| Amnesty International – Italy Country Report            | <a href="https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/italy/report-italy/">https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/italy/report-italy/</a> | Covers key issues like police violence, refugee treatment, and access to justice.    |
| Human Rights Watch – Italy Coverage                     | <a href="https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/italy">https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/italy</a>                                                                     | Investigates ongoing rights issues relevant to UNHRC topics.                         |
| National Office Against Racial                          | <a href="https://unar.it/">https://unar.it/</a>                                                                                                                               | National body reporting to the UN on anti-                                           |

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| Discrimination (UNAR)                             |                                                                                                                                           | racism, hate crimes, and equality efforts.                                 |
| Freedom House – Italy Profile                     | <a href="https://freedomhouse.org/country/italy/freedom-world/2023">https://freedomhouse.org/country/italy/freedom-world/2023</a>         | Index of civil and political rights used in UNHRC assessments.             |
| OHCHR – Universal Periodic Review of Italy (2020) | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/it-index">https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/it-index</a>                             | Tracks peer reviews of Italy's human rights practices by other UN members. |
| Global Detention Project – Italy Reports          | <a href="https://www.globaldetentionproject.org/countries/europe/italy">https://www.globaldetentionproject.org/countries/europe/italy</a> | Independent data on Italy's detention of migrants and asylum seekers.      |
| A Buon Diritto – Human Rights Advocacy in Italy   | <a href="https://www.abuondiritto.it/">https://www.abuondiritto.it/</a>                                                                   | NGO engaged in prison reform, civil liberties, and legal assistance.       |

| Title                              | Link                                               | Relevance                                                     |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Universal Periodic Review – Italy  | <a href="#">OHCHR UPR Central Page (ohchr.org)</a> | Core UPR documents: reports, recommendations, state responses |
| UPR Fourth Cycle Reference Docs    | <a href="#">OHCHR Reference Docs</a>               | Civil society submissions to UPR                              |
| UN Press: Italy's UPR Examination  | <a href="#">OHCHR Press Release</a>                | Announces Italy's upcoming UPR                                |
| UNHCR Italy Fact Sheet (Sept 2024) | <a href="#">UNHCR PDF</a>                          | Refugee statistics & asylum support programming               |
| UNHCR Multi-Country Office         | <a href="#">UNHCR Global Focus</a>                 | Overview of asylum and statelessness operations               |

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| UNHCR Sea Arrivals Data             | <a href="#">UNHCR Data Portal</a>        | Trends and figures on Mediterranean arrivals                    |
| Italy Factsheet (June 2024)         | <a href="#">UNHCR PDF</a>                | Operational update for support partners                         |
| Freedom in the World 2024           | <a href="#">Freedom House Report</a>     | Evaluates political rights and civil liberties                  |
| Freedom on the Net 2024             | <a href="#">Freedom House Net</a>        | Digital rights and online freedom assessment                    |
| HRW World Report 2024 (Italy)       | <a href="#">HRW Italy 2024</a>           | Reports on child detention, racism, resettlement                |
| HRW World Report 2025 (Italy)       | <a href="#">HRW Italy 2025</a>           | Updates on migrant arrivals and child protection                |
| HRW Sea-Rescue Law Challenge        | <a href="#">HRW Constitutional Court</a> | Legal scrutiny of anti-rescue legislation                       |
| HRW Italy-Libya Transit Risk Report | <a href="#">HRW Immigration Deal</a>     | Critiques migrant return measures                               |
| HRW EU Rule-of-Law Scrutiny         | <a href="#">HRW EU Rule Law</a>          | Notes government decree usage & press freedom threats           |
| Amnesty: Migration Detention Abuses | <a href="#">Amnesty 2024 Press</a>       | Highlights inhumane conditions in detention centers             |
| Amnesty Backsliding Rights Report   | <a href="#">Amnesty PDF</a>              | Flags issues: torture, protest rights, migrants                 |
| Amnesty Roma Housing Ruling         | <a href="#">Amnesty Roma</a>             | Council of Europe case on Roma discrimination                   |
| Amnesty Sea SAR Call to Action      | <a href="#">Amnesty SAR PDF</a>          | Urges Italy to improve SAR transparency and safety              |
| Privacy & Data Transfers Study      | <a href="#">arXiv Study</a>              | Analyzes Italian public admin data sharing with non-EEA domains |

## Unique Aspects of Italy's UNHRC Engagement

- 1. High Sea Arrivals & Migrant Pressure** – Over 300,000 refugees expected in 2024; the intense pressure from migration is shaping policies and drawing scrutiny from the UN.
- 2. Detention Abuses Under Fire** – Reports shed light on the harsh and damaging detention conditions faced by migrants and unaccompanied minors.

3. **Judicial Pushback on Rescue Criminalization** – Italy's Constitutional Court is currently examining laws that impose penalties on NGOs engaged in sea rescue operations.
  4. **Cooperation with Libya & Albania Criticized** – UN organizations are raising alarms about sending migrants back to places where their safety is at risk.
  5. **Rule-of-Law Under EU Scrutiny** – EU institutions and Human Rights Watch are raising concerns about the misuse of emergency powers and the ongoing threats to media freedom.
  6. **Digital & Privacy Risk Visibility** – There are growing concerns about data retention, cross-border government data transfers, and the censorship of online content.
  7. **Roma Housing Discrimination Addressed** – European ruling compels Italy to tackle systemic exclusion.
  8. **UPR Transparency & Civic Input** – State and NGO UPR submissions are accessible to the public and play a key role in a well-organized review process.
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